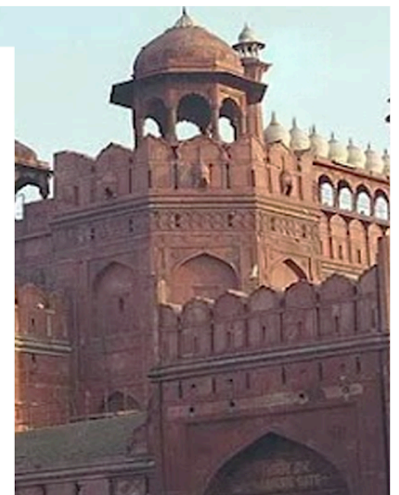
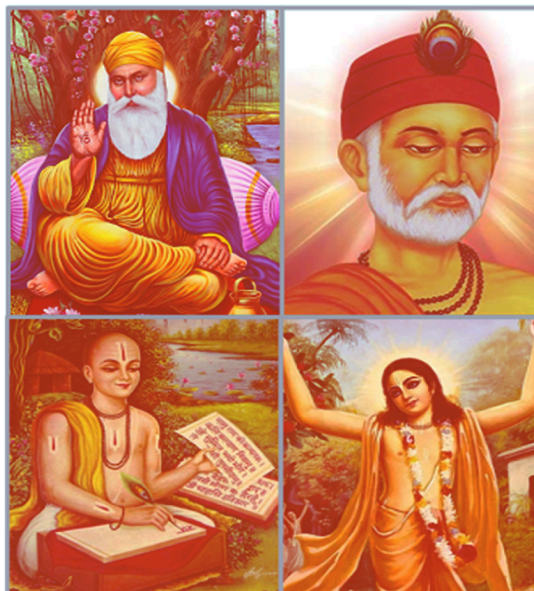
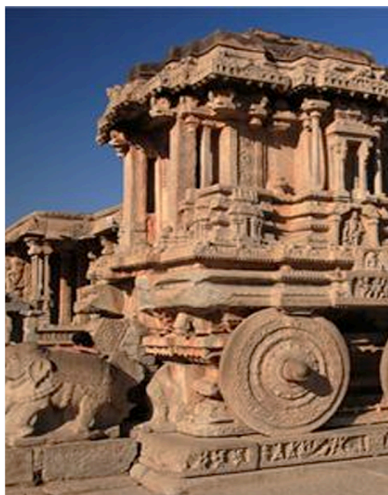


# **General Knowledge**

## **Medieval History**

### **STUDY NOTES**

**RAJPUT RULERS - CHANDELLAS, PARAMARAS &  
SOLANKIS**



## RAJPUT RULERS - CHANDELLAS, PARAMARAS & SOLANKIS



### Rajput Dynasties

- After the **fall of the Gurjar-Pratihara Empire**, several **Rajput states** emerged in **North India**.
- The most significant dynasties included the **Paramaras of Malwa**, the **Chandellas of Bundelkhand**, the **Chaulukyas (Solankis) of Gujarat**, the **Chauhans of Ajmer**, and the **Gahadavalas of Kanauj**.
- There were smaller dynasties like the **Kalachuris of Tripuri** (near present-day **Jabalpur**), the **Loharas of Kashmir**, the **Tomars of Delhi**, and the **Kachchhapaghats of Gwalior**.

### Chandella Dynasty: The Chandellas of Jejakabhukti

- The **Chandellas** ruled **central India (Bundelkhand)** between the **10th and 13th centuries**.
- Their territory was known as **Jejakabhukti**, which corresponds to **modern-day Bundelkhand**.
- The Chandella dynasty had **three capitals: Khajuraho, Kalanjara, and Mahoba**.

## Key Rulers of the Chandella Dynasty

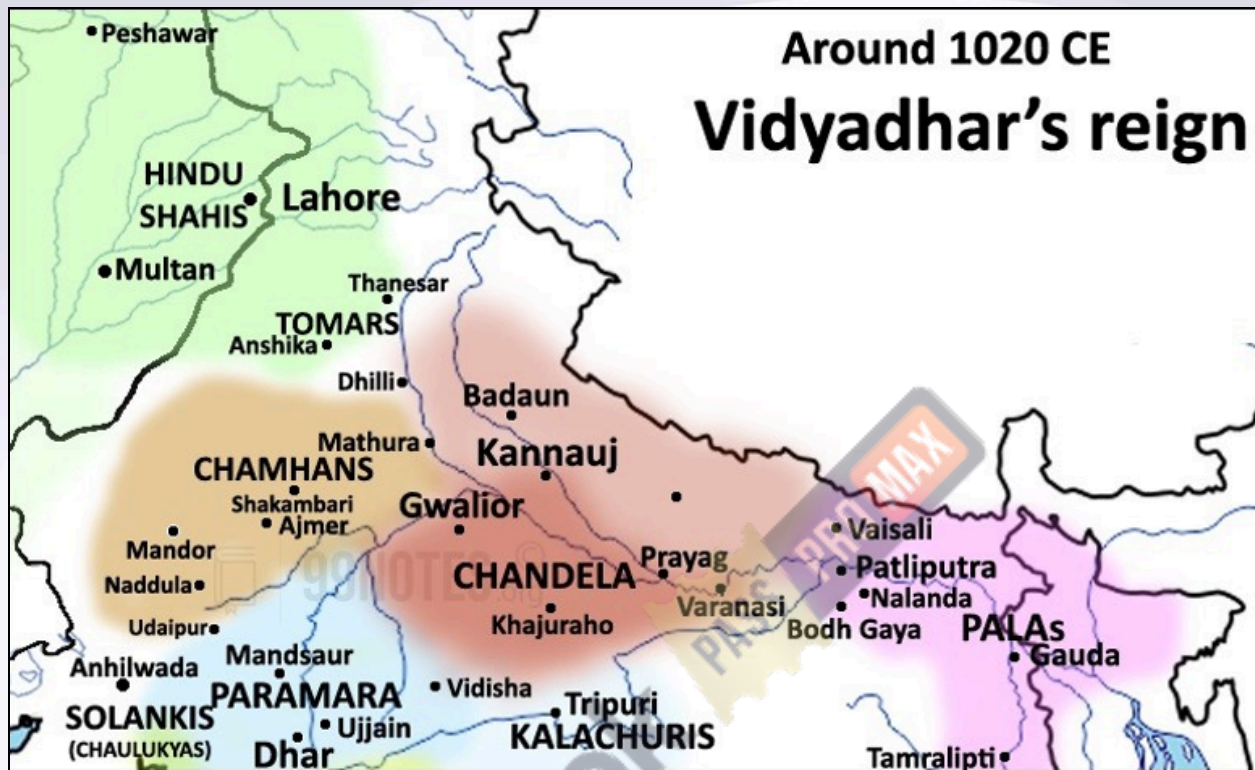
| Ruler                   | Period of Reign | Significance                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nannuka</b>          | 831–845 CE      | Founder of the Chandella dynasty. Ruled Khajuraho as a <b>feudal king under the Pratiharas</b> .                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Dhanga</b>           | 950–999 CE      | Formally <b>established the Chandella sovereignty</b> . Ruled <b>Chedi, Kalinjar, and Gwalior</b> . Expanded territory till the <b>Betwa and Yamuna rivers</b> .                                                 |
| <b>Vidyadhar</b>        | 1003–1035 CE    | <b>Fought invasions by Mahmud of Ghazni</b> . Extended power to its largest extent after <b>capturing Kanauj in 1018</b> .                                                                                       |
| <b>Krittivarman</b>     | 1060–1100 CE    | His death allowed <b>Kalachuris</b> to control the Chandella territory.                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Sallakshanvarman</b> | 1100–1110 CE    | <b>Defeated the Kalachuris and Paramars</b> , briefly reviving Chandella power.                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Parmardi</b>         | 1165–1203 CE    | Last <b>great ruler</b> of the dynasty. Lost territories to <b>Prithviraj Chauhan</b> . His generals, <b>Alha and Udal</b> , died in the <b>Battle of Mahoba</b> . Faced invasion by <b>Qutub-ud-din Aibak</b> . |

## Decline of the Chandella Dynasty

- The **Ghaznavid raids** in the **1020s** weakened the Chandella empire.
- In **1023**, the **Gwalior fort was forced to pay tribute to the Ghaznavids**.
- After **Krittivarman's death** in 1100 CE, the **Kalachuris occupied the Chandella kingdom** for about **four decades**.
- **Sallakshanvarman** revived the Chandella dynasty for a brief period by defeating the **Kalachuris and Paramars**.
- The **final decline** occurred under **Parmardi** (1165–1203 CE), who **lost some territories to Prithviraj Chauhan** and faced an invasion by **Qutub-ud-din Aibak**.



- Although the Chandellas continued to rule for **100 more years**, their **power and influence diminished significantly**.



### Cultural Contributions of the Chandella Dynasty

- The Chandellas were **renowned for their art and architecture**.
- They built several magnificent **temples in Khajuraho**, their original capital.
- The **Kandariya Mahadev Temple** is considered a masterpiece of **aesthetic and architectural brilliance**.
- According to an **inscription in the temple Mandapa**, the temple was built by King **Vrimda**, who is believed to have been a **Chandella ruler**.
- The **artistic and architectural legacy** of the Chandellas reflects their **cultural and historical significance** during their reign.

### Paramar Dynasty: The Paramaras of Malwa

- The **Paramaras** were **originally vassals** established by the **Rashtrakutas** of **Manyakheta** to counter the **Gurjara-Pratiharas**.

- The dynasty ruled over the **Malwa region** between the **9th and 14th centuries**.
- **Capital: Dharanagar** (in present-day **Dhar district, Madhya Pradesh**).
- **Sources for Reconstruction of Parmara History:**
  - **Udaipur Prashasti**
  - **Nagpur Prashasti**

### Independent Rule of the Paramara Dynasty

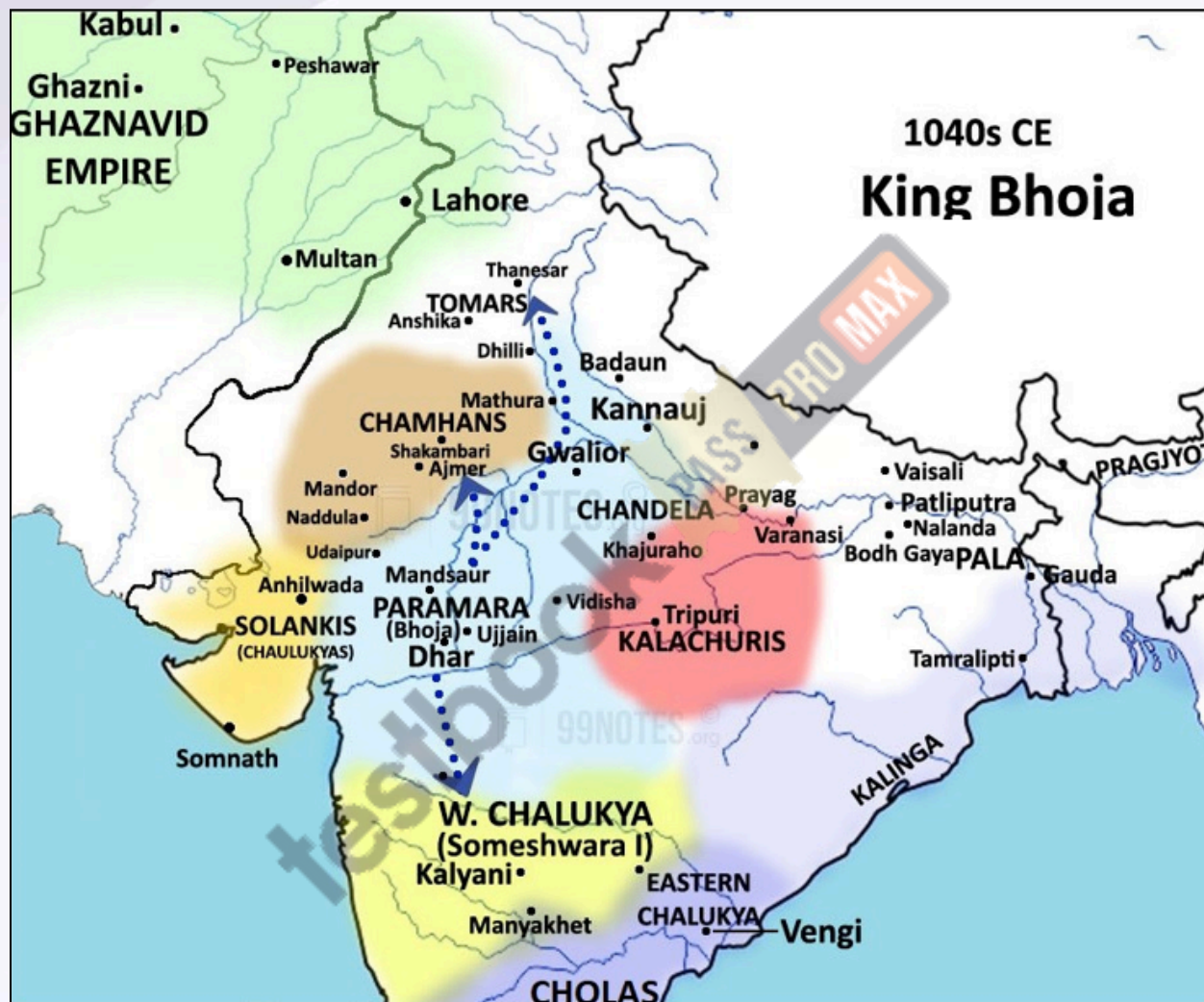
| Ruler         | Period       | Achievements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Siyaka</b> | 940–972 CE   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- First <b>independent ruler</b> of the Paramaras.</li> <li>- Initially a <b>Rashtrakuta feudatory</b> as per the <b>Harsola Copper Plates</b>.</li> <li>- Defeated the Rashtrakutas in <b>948 CE</b>, declaring independence.</li> <li>- <b>Sacked Manyakheta (972 CE)</b>, leading to the <b>downfall of Rashtrakutas</b>.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Bhoja</b>  | 1010–1055 CE | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Brought the Paramara dynasty to its <b>peak power</b>.</li> <li>- Given the title <b>Parameshwara-Parambhattaraka</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

### Expansion Under King Bhoja (1010–1055 CE)

- **Against the Western Chalukyas:**
  - King Bhoja formed a **triple alliance** with **Rajendra Chola** and **Kalachuris** to oppose the **Western Chalukyas**.
- **Against the Ghaznavids:**
  - Bhoja is believed to have supported the **Hindushahis** against **Mahmud of Ghazni**.
  - He may have been part of a **Hindu alliance (1043 CE)** that expelled **Ghaznavid governors** from **Hansi** and **Thanesar**.
- **Against Weaker Neighbours:**
  - He **raided the Chahmana (Chauhan) territory** and possibly **captured their capital, Shakambhari**, for a brief period.

## Cultural Contributions of King Bhoja

- Founded the city of **Bhojapur** and constructed the **Bhojeshwar Temple**.
- Credited with writing books on **philosophy, poetics, and yoga**.
- His court poet **Dasabala** wrote **Chintamani-Sarnika (1055 CE)**.



## Fall of Paramara Power

| Events Leading to Decline | Description                                                                             |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| War of Succession         | A <b>succession war broke out</b> after the death of King Bhoja, weakening the dynasty. |

|                                           |                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kalachuri and Solanki Invasion</b>     | The <b>Kalachuris</b> allied with the <b>Solankis of Gujarat</b> to occupy the Paramara kingdom.                                                      |
| <b>Solanki King Jaysimha's Occupation</b> | <b>Jaysimha Solanki</b> occupied the Paramara kingdom in the <b>late 12th century</b> .                                                               |
| <b>Raids from the South</b>               | In Bhoja's later years, <b>Someshwar I</b> of the Western Chalukyas <b>raided Dhar</b> . Later, <b>Hoysalas and Yadavas of Devagiri</b> also invaded. |
| <b>Delhi Sultanate Incursions</b>         | From the <b>13th century</b> , the <b>Delhi Sultanate</b> frequently attacked the Paramaras.                                                          |
| <b>End of the Dynasty</b>                 | <b>Alauddin Khilji</b> killed the <b>last Paramara ruler in 1305</b> , marking the end of the dynasty.                                                |

## Chaulukya Dynasty: The Chaulukyas/Solankis of Gujarat

- The **Chalukyas** were **feudatories of the Gurjara-Pratiharas**, controlling **Gujarat and Kathiawad** around **950 CE**.
- They **gained independence** by exploiting the **anarchy within the Pratihara kingdom** and established their rule in the **Saraswati Valley**.

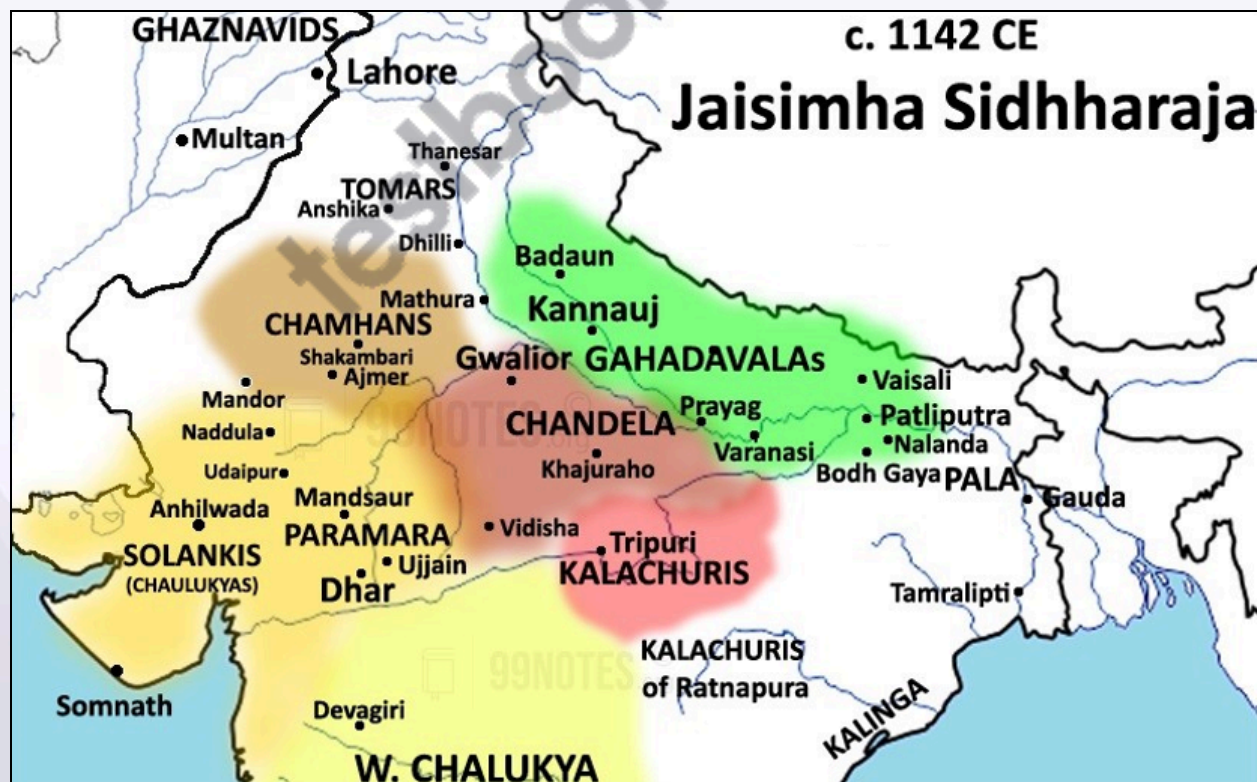
### Independent Rule of Solankis

- **Reign:**
  - The **Solankis** ruled parts of **Gujarat and Rajasthan** between **940–1244 CE**.
  - Their **capital** was at **Anhilawada (modern Patan)**.
- **Notable Events and Conflicts:**
  - During the reign of **Bhimadeva I (1025 CE)**, the **Somanath Temple** was **plundered by Muhammad of Ghazni**.
  - In the **11th century**, the **Solankis** engaged in conflicts with the **Parmaras** and **Chauhans of Shakambari and Nadulla**.



## Key Rulers and Achievements

| Ruler                      | Period       | Achievements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Jaisimha Siddharaja</b> | 1092-1142 CE | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Transformed the <b>Solankis</b> into an imperial power and expanded the kingdom significantly.</li> <li>- <b>Defeated and annexed the Parmara kingdom</b> of Malwa.</li> <li>- <b>Made the Chauhans of Nadulla his vassals.</b></li> <li>- <b>Defeated the Chauhans of Shakambari</b> and allied with them by <b>marrying his daughter</b> to King <b>Arnoraj Chauhan</b>.</li> <li>- Defeated the <b>Soorma ruler of Sindh</b>.</li> <li>- Checked the advance of <b>Vikramaditya VI</b> of the Western Chalukyas.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Kumarpala</b>           | 1143-1172 CE | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Maintained a stronghold over the empire despite <b>frequent rebellions</b>.</li> <li>- Adopted <b>Jainism</b>, but remained <b>fierce in dealing with rebels</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |





## Decline of the Chaulukya Dynasty

- **Ghurid Invasions:**
  - In **1178**, **Mohammad of Ghor** attempted to invade the Chaulukyan territory but was **defeated**.
  - However, after the **fall of the Chauhans**, the **Ghurids captured the Chaulukyan capital Naharwala in 1197 CE**.
- **Paramaras' Independence:**
  - Following the Ghurid invasions, the **Paramaras** regained their independence and **captured the Lata region**.
  - They **raided the Chaulukyan capital**, adding to the dynasty's instability.
- **Southern Invasions:**
  - The Solankis faced repeated **incursions from the Yadavas of Devagiri** from the south.
- **Internal Challenges:**
  - **Northern feudatories** declared independence twice when **Bhima II (1178–1240)** was preoccupied with southern conflicts.
  - **Vaghelas** took control of the kingdom's affairs in the **1240s**, eventually **usurping power** and declaring their own rule.

## Cultural Contributions: Māru-Gurjara Architecture

- The **Māru-Gurjara architecture**, also known as **Solanki architecture**, flourished between the **11th and 13th centuries** in Gujarat and Rajasthan.
- This architectural style includes both **Hindu and Jain temples** with intricate designs and carvings.
- **Famous Examples:**
  - **Sun Temple at Modhera**
  - **Rani-ki-Vav (stepwell)**, built by **Queen Udayamati**